

BTC Dashboard Signal Review

Sep 26, 2026 · @Riyad Kalla

The confirmation review mostly holds, but it could only check your documents against each other. Checked against 2010–2026 price history, three problems change the design. The timing reserve lost to plain buying in all four cycles. The +50%-in-a-year score does not measure what the goal asks. A proven 80% is out of reach for any cycle-level signal.

Today's Deploy call survives. What should change is how it is funded, sized and labeled, the goal's wording, and the sell side.

What the data confirmed

The study's numbers are sound. Every figure the review could not check reproduces from Coin Metrics daily history, 2010 to 23 May 2026.

Claim	Documents say	History says	Status
Confidence floors	60%, 46%, 48%	59.7%, 46.0%, 48.2% as a Wilson 90% lower bound	Reproduced
Weeks followed by a +50% year	60%	61.1% (entry weeks 2012 to May 2025)	Reproduced
Flat-or-down years	29% (strategy only)	26.9% to May 2025; later 2025 entries also fell, lifting it toward 29%	Consistent
July 2020 gap under trend	−18% (strategy only)	−18%	Reproduced
Worst dip in the year after each fire	−27%, −12%, −11%, −9%	−27%, −12%, −11%, −9%	Reproduced
Next-year result after each fire	+127%, +59%, +269%, +138%	+125%, +57%, +269%, +153% counting 52 Fridays	Close; end-date sensitive
Weeks under realized price	79% of 91 hit +50%	79% of 91; 90 of 91 were positive	Reproduced

Claim	Documents say	History says	Status
Trend on 25 Sep 2026	about \$141,000	\$142,000–\$147,000, by fit start year	Consistent
Spot on 25 Sep 2026	about \$84,000	\$84,413	Confirmed

So the review's Unverified and Extension flags on –18%, the dip series, the 29% and the "90% interval" were procedural. The reviewer was barred from computing; the numbers are right.

Problem 1: the reserve lost to plain buying every cycle

The buy cross went 4 for 4. A reserve that sat in cash waiting for it went 0 for 4 against buying the same dollars as they arrived.

The study scored each fire against the next 12 months. It never scored the reserve against the obvious alternative. Because Bitcoin trends up, each fire was priced above the last, so cash carried between episodes bought fewer coins.

Waiting period	Weeks	Average cost, buying weekly	Price at next fire	Reserve's coins vs weekly buying
Mar 2023 → Sep 2026	166	\$55,509	\$81,000	31% fewer
Jul 2020 → Mar 2023	136	\$25,574	\$27,451	7% fewer
May 2019 → Jul 2020	64	\$8,606	\$11,338	24% fewer
Jul 2015 → May 2019	196	\$921	\$5,658	84% fewer

The latest row uses weekly prices through 22 May 2026. The missing summer weeks traded near \$60,000–\$84,000 and do not change the sign. A reserve refilled right after one fire and held to the next did worse still: 2.0 to 19.6 times fewer coins.

The buy cross is a good moment to buy, but a bad reason to hold cash. The cost sits in the years between episodes, not the weeks inside one. Whether cash should wait from arm to fire is a separate question the study has not answered.

The immediate buy is also the more faithful one. Spreading over three Fridays cost 1–13% more than the fire Friday in three of four episodes. Spreading over 26 weeks cost 2–60% more. The goal's \$100,000 immediate buy fits the evidence better than the strategy's three slices.

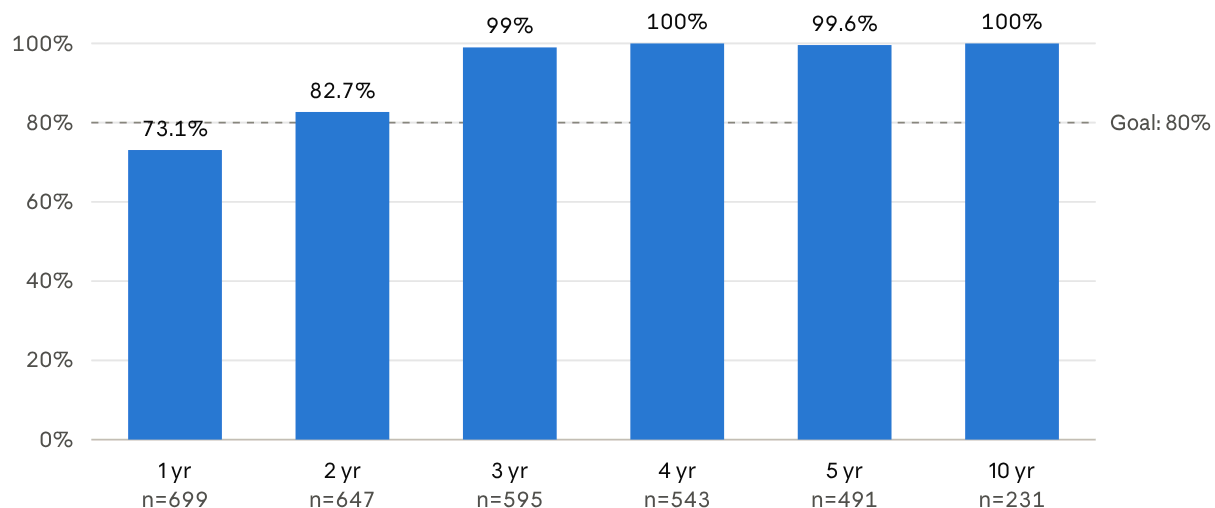
Problem 2: the +50% score measures the wrong thing

The goal asks for the most Bitcoin over 1, 5 and 10 years. The study scores whether the next 12 months gained 50%. Those are different targets.

Two entries the strategy calls failures show the gap. The first week under realized price, 31 October 2014, was down 3% a year later and up 105% two years later. June 2022 returned +29%, then +222%. Both fail the +50% rule, yet both more than doubled within two years.

Holds of three years or more were up in 99 to 100% of entry weeks

Share of weekly entries since 2012 that were up at each horizon (%)



Holding period after a weekly entry (n = entry weeks with a finished result)

Coin Metrics PriceUSD, Friday closes · entries Jan 2012 onward · data to 22 May 2026

The only statement in the data that clears 80% is not a timing signal: hold three years or more. The worst 4-year result was +35% (entry April 2021). The worst 5-year result was -3% (entries at the December 2017 peak).

Treat that as a base rate, not proof. There are fewer than three non-overlapping 5-year windows since 2012, and early-era growth inflates it. It is still the honest answer to the goal's 5- and 10-year clauses.

The fix: score every action against the default of keeping on buying and holding. Measure coins accumulated and after-tax dollars at 1, 2 and 4 years. Keep the hit rate beside those numbers, never alone.

Problem 3: a proven 80% is out of reach for cycle signals

The strategy's high-confidence gate can never be met as written. The study's floors match a Wilson 90% interval exactly. On that method, eight straight wins give a floor of 74.7%, not 80%.

Record	Floor	Clears 80%?
4 of 4 (buy cross today)	59.7%	No
8 of 8 (the strategy's gate)	74.7%	No
10 of 10	78.7%	No
11 of 11	80.3%	Yes
19 of 20	80.4%	Yes
16 of 16 (the study's 85% Very High)	85.5%	Yes

The buy cross has fired about every 2.8 years, five times from July 2015 to September 2026. Eleven straight completed wins means six more after this one, all successful: the mid-2040s at the earliest. One miss moves the target to 19 of 20.

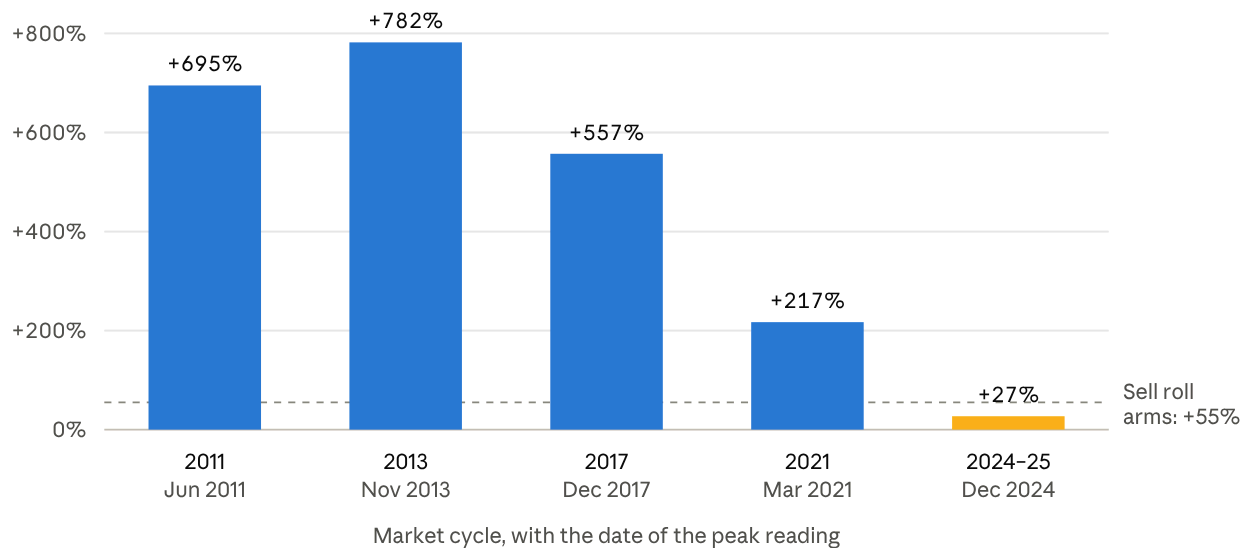
No rule that fires once per cycle can meet "proven 80%" while Bitcoin has had about four cycles since 2012. Only two routes exist. Rules with many more episodes, which scored lower floors in the tests below. Or statements with a high base rate, like long holds. The goal should say this plainly, rather than leaving the strategy to absorb the conflict.

The sell side is fading

The sell roll arms only when price is at least 55% over the trend. That zone has not been reached since 2021, and each cycle's peak has come in lower.

Each cycle's peak over the trend has shrunk, to +27% this cycle

Highest daily close above the expanding power-law trend, by cycle (%)



Coin Metrics PriceUSD, daily · expanding log-log fit from July 2010 · data to 23 May 2026

Three consequences follow.

- **It was silent through the latest decline.** From the October 2025 high of \$124,824 (daily close), price fell 49% by February 2026. It also missed June 2019 to March 2020 (−61%). It fired during five of the seven 40%+ declines since 2012.
- **It usually fired late.** Five of eight fires came after price was already 44–60% below its high. Only September 2017, May 2021 and December 2021 fired near a top.
- **The 6-of-8 record counts only how often a fire was right.** It never counts the declines the rule missed. A sell rule needs both on the same line.

The posture also does not use the edge it cites. Stand down lasts three Fridays, but its record is about the next 12 months. A three-week pause barely moves a portfolio. The strategy never says where paused cash goes; if it just sits, stand down lowers total investment, against the goal.

Corrections to confirmation-findings.md

The review is careful and I agree with most verdicts. Six calls should change, and it missed four problems.

1. **B1 should be Refused, not Conflict.** The plan says: "Refused if the strategy shows the action and prints a lower floor." The strategy does exactly that. A rule written for this case should beat the general two-way rule. The count becomes Conflict 5, Refused 1,

which points the fix at goal.md.

2. **Ruling 1 is mislabeled.** It says "strategy yields," but its reasoning is that the goal must stop calling the action 80%. The strategy already refuses 80%. It should read "goal yields."
3. **Ruling 4 is also mostly a goal yield.** Its reasoning narrows the goal's "all the Signals" to the decision set. Only the thermometer and the six-rung (A6) are strategy concessions.
4. **A6's realized-price Conflict double-counts A10.** "Not a trigger" in the write-up targets the first-week lump sum. Pacing buys during the cheap state is the plain reading of "coins are cheap." The untested part is the 26-week schedule, which A10 already marks.
5. **The A9 numbers are right.** The -18% gap, the dip series, the 29% and the 90% interval all reproduce. They remain additions to the write-up, not errors.
6. **B4 compares unlike scores.** The buy cross was scored on hit rate; its parts were scored on rung credit. The only like-for-like test is the lift: 11 of 16 without the trough, 4 of 4 with it. The Deploy-plus-Build week is not claimed as a stronger signal, so it should not fail B4.

What the review missed:

- **The 80% gate is impossible as written.** Eight episodes cannot reach an 80% floor (Problem 3), so the strategy's "what would change this document" line can never trigger.
- **Stand down's length does not match its evidence.** Three Fridays of action rest on a 12-month record, and paused cash has no destination.
- **Build's spell rule fragments in real bears.** 2022 had three spells in seven months (5, 11 and 9 weeks). Under "a new tranche starts after a later, separate spell," that opens three tranches in one bear. A 26-week tranche finished in only one of the six spells since 2015; 2022's three spells used 19%, 42% and 35% of theirs.
- **Nothing scores the reserve against buying as cash arrives** (Problem 1).

Proposed changes to goal.md

Most Fails and Conflicts trace back to a goal that asks for things the history cannot supply. Amend the goal rather than bend the strategy. Proposed replacement:

Develop a Dashboard that tells a Bitcoin holder what to do each week, on a spectrum from "Exit" to "All in," and shows how much history stands behind each call.

Every action shows its record, a confidence floor (the Wilson 90% lower bound), and the number of independent episodes behind it. High confidence means a floor of 80% or more. An action may appear before it earns that badge, but never with a confidence it has not earned.

Actions are judged against the default of steady buying and holding, not a fixed return bar. The scores are coins accumulated and after-tax dollar value at 1, 5 and 10 years. Timing signals are judged at 1 year. The 5- and 10-year views are about allocation and whether the long-term thesis still holds.

Signals are scored on all complete data (2012 onward), with open episodes shown as open.

The dashboard answers two questions. What to do with cash: from pausing, through dollar-cost averaging, to an immediate \$100,000 buy as the boldest action. What to do with coins held: hold, trim in steps to an allocation limit, or exit entirely, and exit only when the long-term thesis breaks.

What changes, and which findings it settles:

- **"Proven 80%" becomes a floor shown on every action**, with 80% kept as the badge. Settles B1, the buy half of B3, and B11.
- **"Maximize investment" gets a definition**. I propose coins accumulated plus after-tax dollars; see open questions.
- **"Since 2010 through Sep 2026" becomes "all complete data."** Prices start in 2010, finished scoring in 2012, and an open episode cannot be finished. Settles B2.
- **"Sell all" is reserved for a broken thesis**. Cycle sells were punished (+565% and +85% after two fires), and selling long-held coins triggers capital-gains tax. Settles B6, B8 and B9 without a fake test.
- **Horizons split**: timing at 1 year, allocation and thesis at 5 and 10. Settles B10.
- **The \$100,000 immediate buy stays**. B7 becomes a strategy fix, below.

Proposed changes to signal-quality.md

None of the standard missing signals beats the buy cross. The real gain is a sizing rule the study never tested, plus three scoring fixes.

Scoring fixes:

1. **Add a payoff column.** Score each action against the default in coins and after-tax dollars at 1, 2 and 4 years.
2. **Add recall to every sell rule.** Count declines caught, declines missed, and how far into the decline the rule fired.
3. **Put independent episodes beside weekly counts.** The 91 cheap weeks are four spells; a floor on 91 would overstate it.

New rows, tested here on the same data (my own implementations, standard settings, no tuning):

Signal	Result	Suggested use
Power-law gap as a lump-sum-or-DCA switch	20%+ under trend: a lump sum beat a 52-week DCA in 93% of 353 weeks, with a median 55% more coins (91% in 2012–17, 94% in 2018–25). 55%+ over trend: DCA won 65% of 130 weeks, 85% since 2018. In between: no edge (51–59%).	Keep. This measures the goal's "switch to DCA" clause. Weeks overlap, so read it as a few regimes, not 699 trials.
Timing reserve vs buying as cash arrives	Reserve got 7–84% fewer coins in all four cycles	Do not hold a standing reserve between episodes.
Long holds (base rate)	Up in 99.0%, 100%, 99.6% and 100% of entry weeks at 3, 4, 5 and 10 years	Show as 5- and 10-year context. Not a signal.
Hash ribbons (miner capitulation ends)	16 of 21 distinct fires hit +50%, floor 59%; 17 of 21 were positive. Every 2025 fire with a finished year lost 19–29%.	Low. More episodes, same floor as the buy cross, and fading.

Signal	Result	Suggested use
Trend exits (200-day, 50-week, 20W/21W band)	85–97% a year before tax vs 91% for holding; worst drawdown –64% to –70% vs –82%. Only 4 of 25, 4 of 10 and 7 of 27 exits bought back cheaper.	Do not use as a sell. Wins only on payoff, and tax on long-held coins erases that.
Mayer multiple under 0.8	44% of 109 weeks hit +50%; 69% were positive	Drop. Weaker than the realized-price flag.
200-week SMA	Price was under it only in September 2015 and June 2022 to October 2023	Map line only. Too few episodes.

Diagnostics to add:

- **Power-law peak decay.** Cycle peaks over trend ran +782%, +557%, +217%, +27%. The +55% line may be out of reach for good.
- **Power-law fit sensitivity.** The September 2026 gap ranges from –29% to –46% as the fit start moves from 2010 to 2017, with slopes from 4.95 to 5.98. The arm condition holds under every fit; long-range trend targets do not.
- **The gold leg of the z-score.** Over the past year BTC fell 23% while gold rose 17%, so about 38% of the ratio's fall came from gold. Show both legs and flag arms or fires that gold drove.

Candidates worth testing that need data I did not have here:

- **Macro liquidity:** Fed net liquidity, global M2, real yields, the dollar, and high-yield credit spreads. Long histories exist. Test them as a filter on Stand down, not as timers, and watch for lag-fitting.
- **Spot ETF flows and corporate treasury buying.** Too short to score (2024 on), but they are the new marginal buyer. Show them as context and as a regime flag on every pre-2024 calibration.
- **Thesis-break monitors for Exit:** a sustained break below the power-law floor band (not the trend), a lasting hash-rate collapse, a credible break of Bitcoin's signature scheme with no migration path, or prohibition across major markets. These cannot be backtested; label them as risk rules.

Proposed changes to signal-strategy.md

Keep the buy cross, the realized-price flag, and the discipline around them. Rebuild the postures around two questions, cash and coins, so one spectrum runs from Exit to All in. Each row carries its own evidence line.

Posture	Cash	Coins held	Evidence
All in	Up to \$100,000 of cash on hand goes in on the fire Friday. The next two Fridays are grace for a missed check, not slices. Build also runs if under cost.	Hold	Buy cross 4 of 4, floor 60%. The fire Friday beat three slices in 3 of 4.
Lump in	Cash on hand goes in at once when price is 20%+ under trend and the cross is not armed	Hold	Lump beat a 52-week DCA in 93% of those weeks
Build	One tranche in weekly slices while the realized-price ratio is below 1	Hold	79% of 91 cheap weeks hit +50%; 90 of 91 were up. Schedule untested.
Stay the course	Standing contribution. New lump sums either way; no edge.	Hold	The default. 3+ year holds were up in 99%+ of weeks.
Slow in	New lump sums spread over 12 months when price is 55%+ over trend	Hold	DCA won 65% of those weeks, 85% since 2018
Stand down	Pause new money for up to 12 months, matching the record. Paused cash waits in T-bills and goes in when Build or All in fires.	Hold	Sell roll 6 of 8, floor 46%; missed 2019–20 and 2025–26. The longer pause is untested.
Trim	None	Sell in slices down to a target allocation, highest-cost lots first	A policy, not a signal. A sell-roll fire can speed it up.

Posture	Cash	Coins held	Evidence
Exit	None	Sell all	Thesis-break rules only. Cannot be backtested.

Other fixes:

- **Replace the timing reserve with "cash on hand."** Do not refill a reserve to wait years for the next cross. While the cross is armed, keep the strategy's wait-for-the-fire rule until the arm-to-fire test is run.
- **Fix the confidence gate.** Use the floor alone (80% needs 11 of 11 or 19 of 20) and delete the eight-episode line.
- **Give Build a spell rule that survives choppy bears.** For example, a spell ends only after several straight Fridays above cost, and a leftover carries into the next spell instead of opening a new tranche. Pick the number and freeze it before testing.
- **Show the sell roll's misses and silence.** "Not armed since 2021; missed 2019–20 and 2025–26" belongs beside the posture.
- **Split the z-score into its BTC and gold legs** on the chart.
- **Restore the macro-pressure thermometer** as non-voting context, as the quality write-up allows (settles A6).
- **Put a tax line on every coin-selling posture.** For an Arizona resident, long-term gains face up to 20% federal, 3.8% net investment income tax and 2.5% state. Confirm lot selection and wash-sale treatment with a tax adviser.

What this means for 26 September 2026

The call does not flip. The buy cross fired on 18 September near \$81,000, and BTC was \$84,413 on 25 September. Under the strategy and under these proposals, cash on hand goes in now.

The size, the funding and the label change:

- **Size:** up to \$100,000 in the fire window, rather than \$50,000 in three slices. One grace Friday remains, 2 October.
- **Funding:** cash already on hand, not a reserve built up to wait.
- **Label:** "4 of 4, floor 60%. Open episode. Not high confidence."
- **Build stays off:** price is well above the realized price near \$53,000.

This cross carries two caveats the earlier four did not.

- **The trend's level is disputed.** Peaks over trend have faded every cycle, and today's gap is -29% to -46% depending on the fit. The arm condition holds under every fit, but this is the first fire where the model itself is in question.
- **Gold did part of the arming.** Gold rose from \$3,723 to \$4,360 over the year, about 38% of the ratio's fall. The fire itself was Bitcoin-led: BTC rose 10.4% in the week to 25 September, while gold barely moved in September (\$4,331 on the 1st, \$4,360 on the 21st).

This is research, not financial advice. For a position this size, a fee-only fiduciary and a tax adviser should check it against your full balance sheet.

Open questions and next tests

Five answers from you decide how the strategy is rewritten:

1. **What does "maximize investment" mean:** most coins, most after-tax dollars, or dollars with a drawdown limit? The rules differ.
2. **Where does the \$100,000 come from:** cash you hold now, or a pile you would refill? The reserve result argues against refilling.
3. **Where are the coins held:** a taxable account, an IRA, or an ETF? That decides whether Trim and Exit are practical.
4. **What is your target Bitcoin share** of investable net worth, and what ceiling should trigger Trim?
5. **Should the 1-year timing panel and the 5- and 10-year allocation panel** be shown separately?

Next tests, in order. Freeze the constants first, as the strategy already requires.

- ☐ **Arm to fire:** buy at arm, wait for the fire, or DCA between them, scored in coins. Needs the gold series; settles whether Lump in and the wait-for-fire rule conflict.
- ☐ **Whole-portfolio backtest** of the posture set against steady DCA, after tax, in coins and dollars at 1, 2 and 4 years.
- ☐ **Volatility-scaled power-law bands** (quantiles of the residual) in place of the fixed -20% and $+55\%$. This is a new study.
- ☐ **Build's spell rule** replayed on the 2015 and 2022 bears.
- ☐ **Macro liquidity** as a Stand down filter.
- ☐ **Gold-leg split** of every past arm and fire.

Sources and data notes

- **Price, realized-price ratio and hash rate:** [Coin Metrics community data](#), daily from 18 July 2010 to 23 May 2026. The file ends before June, so the June low and September readings come from your documents and the pages below.
- **BTC on 25 September 2026:** [Fortune](#) and [Yahoo Finance](#).
- **Gold:** [Fortune, 21 September 2026](#) and [Fortune, 1 September 2026](#).
- **Method:** Friday closes, an expanding log-log power-law fit on daily closes, and a Wilson 90% interval for floors. No fees, slippage or taxes in the backtests.
- **Limits:** weekly windows overlap, so weekly percentages overstate the evidence. Buy-cross dates come from signal-quality.md; I did not rebuild the gold z-score. Sell-roll fires are known only by month, so they are measured from each month's first Friday.